VICTORY 2026

HISTORY

The Second World War

Lecture-01

By – Kunal Sir



Topics *to be covered*

1. Causes of War



The Second World War

Causes (Dissatisfaction with the Treaty of Versailles, Rise of Fascism and Nazism, Policy of Appeasement, Japanese invasion of China, Failure of League of Nations and Hitler's invasion of Poland). Brief mention of the attack on Pearl Harbour and bombing of Hiroshima and Nagasaki. Consequences (Defeat of Axis Powers, Formation of the United Nations and Cold War).

(d) United Nations

Diwali Hardik ShubhKamnaye ..Hui..Hui...



Mitr Badmoshi Nahi ,
World War Karte Hai Hum





Which of the following was not a cause of the Second World War?

(A) The Treaty of Versailles

(B) Rise of Nazism in Italy Germany

(C) German Invasion of Poland

(D) Murder of the Crown Prince of Austria and his wife at Sarajevo



The second World War

1. The First World War and its harsh peace treaties sowed the seeds for the Second World War.

2. The damage caused by the Second World War surpassed all other wars and almost caused the complete destruction of the world

WW II

(1939 – 1945)

CAUSES OF WORLD WAR II





1. Dissatisfaction with the Treaty of Versailles:

1. The Treaty of Versailles, by which the First World War came to an end, created more problems than it solved.

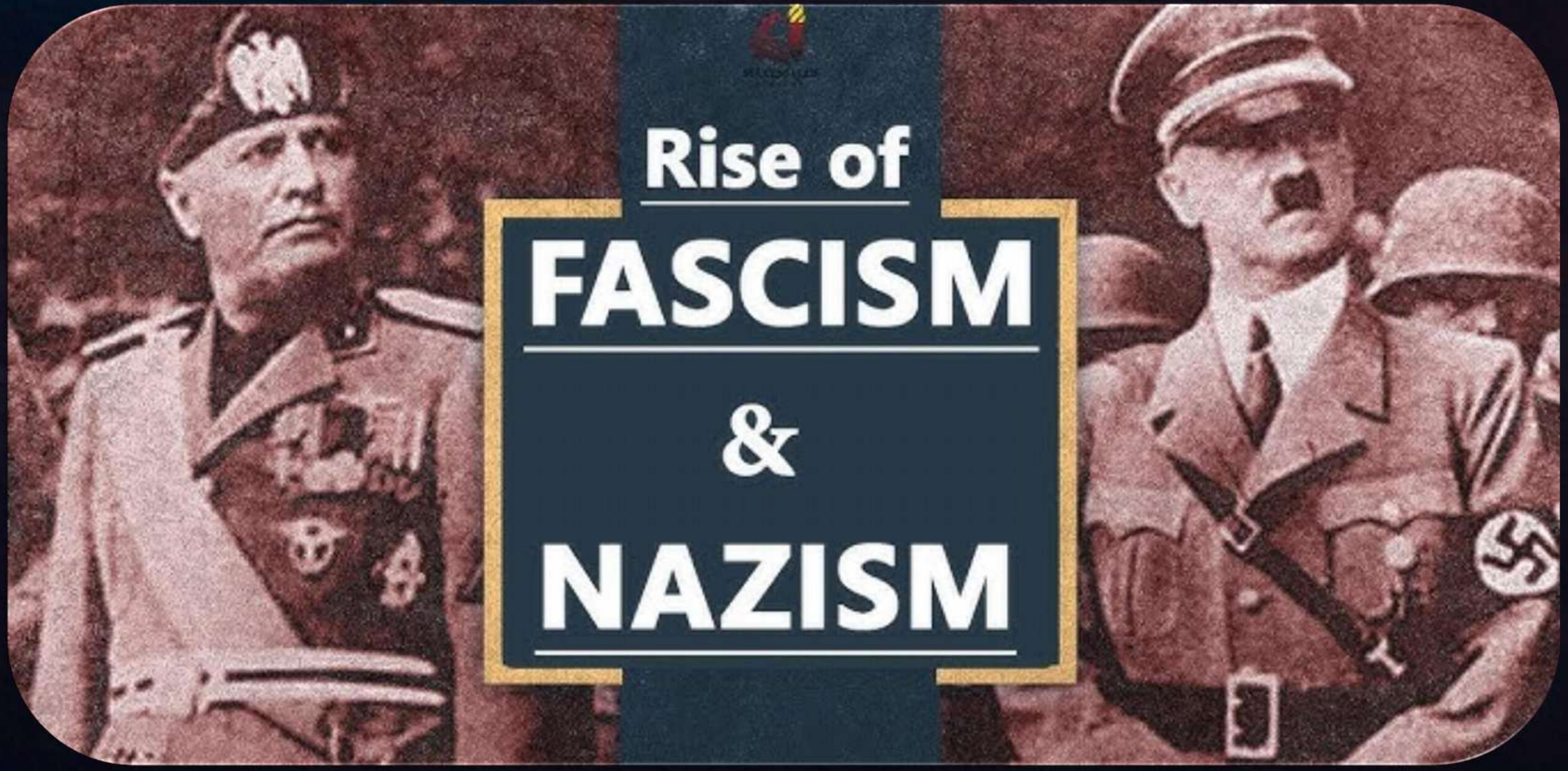
2. The treaty demanded annexation of German territories and creation of many States.

3. This caused bitterness and conflict. In fact, this treaty was based on the spirit of revenge and Germany was forced to sign the treaty.



1. Dissatisfaction with the Treaty of Versailles:

1. All the German colonies were forcibly taken away from her and she was divided into two parts for the benefit of Poland.
2. She was burdened with huge war indemnity which she could never pay. Her military power was reduced.
   ↳ Compensation
3. This humiliation gave rise to the spirit of revenge and Germany started looking for an opportunity to do away with the harsh treaty.
4. But this was not possible without an aggressive policy and armaments. Hence, the war became inevitable.
   ↳ that cannot be avoided


Rise of
FASCISM
&
NAZISM



2. Rise of Fascism and Nazism:

1. The rise of extreme nationalism in Italy and Germany in the form of Fascism and Nazism, respectively contributed to the causes which led to the Second World War. Italy wanted to revive the glory of the Old Roman empire.
2. She joined the Anti-Comintern Pact in 1937 and formed a ten years alliance with Germany in 1939 to strengthen her position. Mussolini established dictatorship in Italy. He opposed the Treaty of Versailles.
3. Italy demonstrated her imperialistic designs by attacking Abyssinia(Ethiopia). The League of Nations failed to take any action against Italy, which exhibited the weakness of the League.



2. Rise of Fascism and Nazism:

1. In Germany, Hitler wanted to re-establish the prestige of Germany in the international field. He flouted the military clauses in the Treaty of Versailles and declared re-armament.

2. In 1938, he annexed Austria and dismembered erstwhile Czechoslovakia. Thus, Mussolini and Hitler drove the countries of the world towards another World War.

Meaning → break the country

Sudentenland → annex

German speaking population → border

Mussolini opposed the Treaty of _____.

(A) Abyssinia

(B) Versailles

(C) Germany

(D) Czechnoslovakia



3. Policy of Appeasement:

1. Appeasement refers to the policy of conciliating an aggressive power at the expense of some other country.

2. It meant accepting the hostile demands of an aggressive nation to gain peace.

3. Britain and France followed the policy of appeasement towards dictatorial countries like Germany and Italy because they felt that the dictators had a real cause of grievance due to the humiliating terms of the Treaty of Versailles and if their grievances were removed they would not disturb world peace.



3. Policy of Appeasement:

1. Further, they wanted to check the rising influence of Communism and Russian Bolshevism.
2. Britain and France feared that Germany would divert towards Russian Bolshevism.
3. They, therefore, allowed Germany to rearm and to remilitarize the Rhineland and capture Austria and Czechoslovakia.
4. So without the Western countries' **policy of appeasement**, Fascism or Nazism could not have survived so long and would not have been able to cause the Second World War.



4. Japanese Invasion of China:

1. Japanese policy of expansion was another cause of the War. Japan's ambitions rose after the First World War. She was determined to dominate the Far East.

2. In 1931, Japan intervened in Manchuria (northeast Chinese part) and, in spite of the League's opposition, occupied it and set up a government there. Japan also started an undeclared war against China in 1931.

3. China appealed to the League of Nations to declare sanctions against Japan. Britain and France, the leading members of the League did not pay any attention to the appeal.



4. Japanese Invasion of China:

1. Japan joined the Berlin-Rome Axis to form the Berlin-Rome-Tokyo Axis to further its policy of expansion and conquest.

2. In 1933, Japan left the League of Nations and started occupying the British and American properties in China.

3. Britain and France followed the policy of appeasement, thinking that the Japanese could be used to weaken China. Thus, a war was inevitable under these circumstances.



5. Failure of the League of Nations

1. League of Nations was formed after First World War to prevent future wars.
2. However, the League suffered an early blow when the USA did not join the League. Even those who joined the League were not interested in the principle of collective security.
3. The League of Nations succeeded in preventing the threat of war in cases where the parties were small nations.
4. The League did nothing when Poland, with the backing of France, seized a part of Lithuania in 1920.

1. In 1923, there was a threat of war between Italy and Greece.
2. Italy refused to submit to the League's intervention and the dispute was settled by direct mediation of Great Britain and France.
3. Thereafter, in every crisis, the League was either defied or ignored.
4. The authority of the League was flouted by Japan when it seized Manchuria; and by Italy when it conquered Ethiopia.

People To League of Nations



1. The policy of giving warnings -of the League was not adequate to perform the task given to it.
2. The economic sanctions were of no use against a determined aggressor.
3. Moreover, the member states were not willing to apply economic sanctions as it affected their economy as well.
4. Besides, the League failed to maintain international peace and the countries of Europe lost faith in its usefulness.
5. Thereafter, they themselves entered into mutual political and military alliances.



6. Hitler's Invasion of Poland (Immediate Cause):

Hitler invaded Poland in September 1939 for the following reasons:

(i) By the Treaty of Versailles, Germany was divided into two parts in order to give a land-route to Poland up to the sea and the Port of Danzig was also given to Poland. Germany wanted to regain her lost territories.

(ii) The city of Danzig was inhabited mainly by the Germans and by occupying Danzig Corridor, Germany could connect with East Prussia.

(iii) Germany signed a Non-Aggression Pact with Russia in August 1939, Poland was accused of committing atrocities against Germans living there.

↳ cruelty

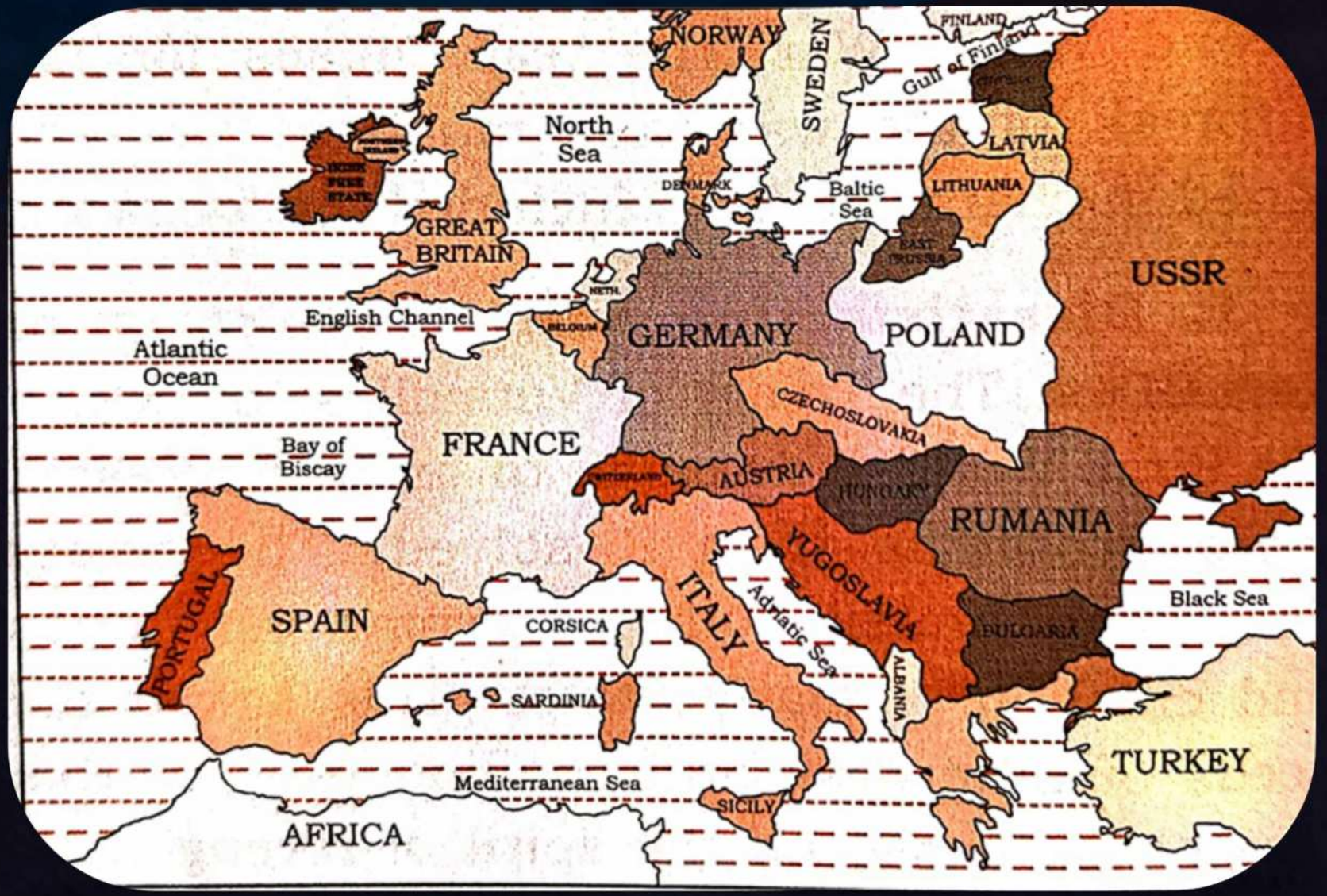
Which of the following was the immediate cause of The World War II?

(A) Japanese Invasion of China

(B) Failure of League of Nations

(C) Hitler's Invasion of Poland

(D) Rise of Fascism and Nazism

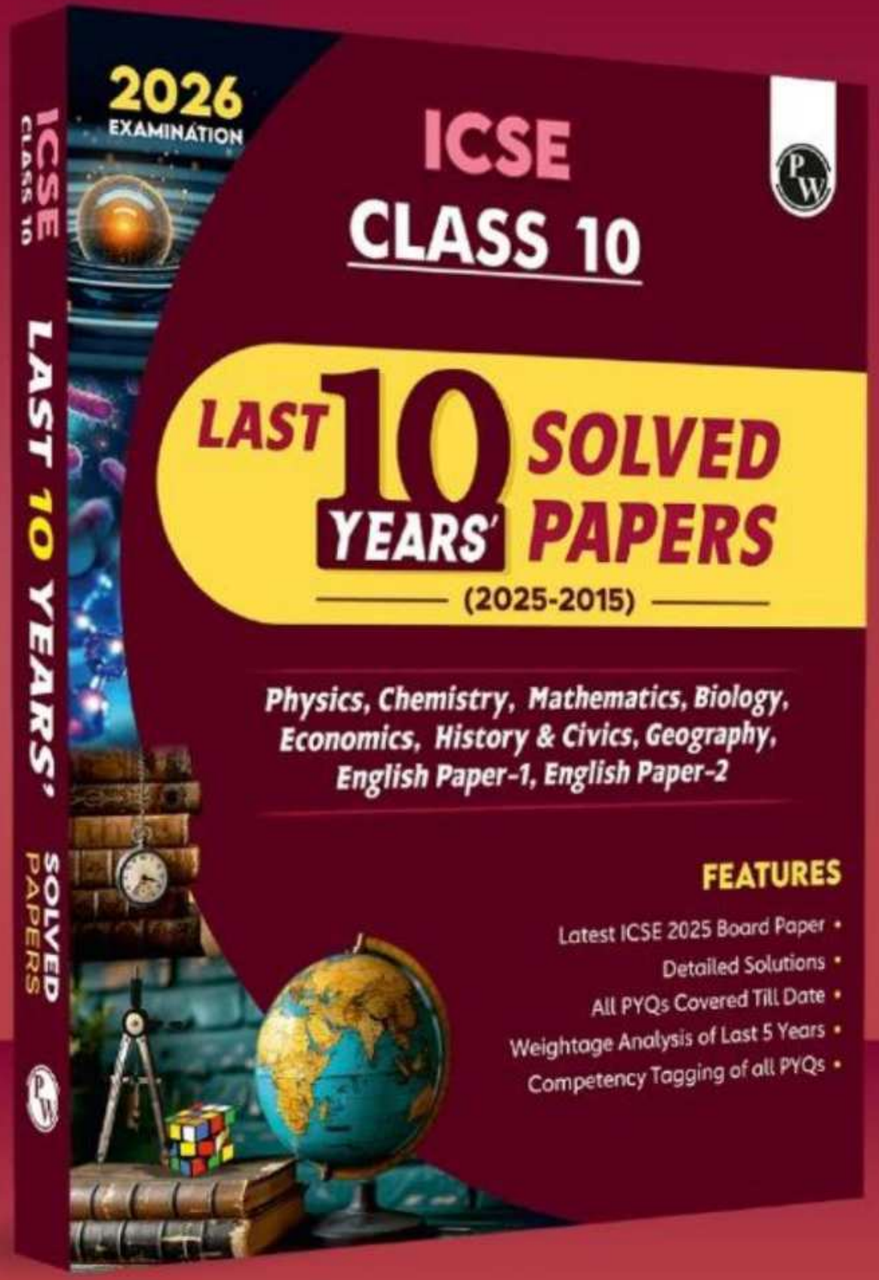


Europe Before World II

1. On September 1, 1939, the German armies marched into Poland. France and Britain gave an ultimatum to Germany.
   ↳ Warning
2. In reply, Germany attacked France. On September 3, Britain and France declared war on Germany. Thus the invasion of Poland marked the beginning of the Second World War.

3. The German armies completed the conquest of Poland in less than three weeks so as to ensure that no aid reached Poland.
   ↳ help
4. In spite of the declaration of War, there was little actual fighting for many months. Therefore, the war during this period from September 1939 to April 1940 was dormant.
   (less aggressive)

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Ques

Japan invaded ____ area of China

(a) Kyoto
(b) Manchuria
(c) Munich
(d) Rome


Thank You